# Abdou Yaackoubi

**Senior Product Designer** · UX/UI · Tunis, Tunisia

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## Profile

Product designer with 6+ years across AI, fintech, SaaS and marketplaces. What I enjoy most is the problem itself: working out what people actually need, finding the simplest solution that works, and staying with it until it ships. I'm currently a Senior Product Designer at InstaDeep (a BioNTech company), designing tools that help people understand and act on machine-learning results. Before that I was the first designer at SteerAI, where we took three products from zero to launch, and the first designer at Konnect, which went on to become Tunisia's first licensed payment facilitator.

I've mostly worked in small teams, close to engineering and reporting to founders. I take features from research to design QA, build and maintain design systems, and prototype in code with Claude Code to test how things behave before they're built. I speak Arabic, English and French, and I'm used to presenting to founders, clients and enterprise stakeholders.

## Experience

**Senior Product Designer (UX/UI)** · InstaDeep, a BioNTech company · Tunis — Jan 2024 – Present

- Design across three product surfaces: DeepPCB, a reinforcement-learning PCB router; InstaNovo, a de novo peptide-sequencing model published in *Nature Machine Intelligence*; and the design system behind both.
- Design dashboards and decision tools that turn complex model outputs into clear next steps for technical and enterprise users, including what they see when results are missing, wrong or uncertain.
- Maintain and grow the design system: more than ten demo applications for clients, partners and BioNTech have been built on it, and engineering has implemented its core components in code.
- Designed the InstaNovo brand and launch pages (landing, enterprise, pricing and onboarding), from a visitor's first look to sign-up.
- Prototype tricky interactions in code before handoff, then work with engineers on specs and design QA.

**Product Designer Lead** · SteerAI · Tunis — Oct 2021 – Nov 2023

- First designer at an automotive-retail tech company. Led design across web and mobile, set product direction with the founders and reported to them directly.
- Shipped three products from zero to launch: a B2B marketing site, a B2B SaaS platform for used-car professionals, and a two-sided used-car marketplace built on verified inspection data and a pricing algorithm. Also designed the brand identity.
- Built the design system and shared UX patterns used across all products, which made new screens faster to deliver.
- Ran discovery with the CTO, engineering and marketing (interviews, journey maps, usability tests) and turned the findings into roadmap priorities. Set up regular research, design critiques and handoff standards.

**UX/UI Designer** · Groupado · Tunis — Feb 2021 – Sep 2021

- Designed the website and mobile app for a skills marketplace where anyone can teach what they know, from user flows to production-ready screens.
- Reworked the navigation and information architecture so people could finish core tasks more easily, and designed the homepage around search visibility from the start.

**UX/UI Designer** · Konnect · Tunis — Feb 2020 – Jan 2021

- First and only designer, working with 15+ engineers and two product managers on one of Tunisia's first digital wallets.
- Designed the MVP that launched (brand, mobile app and landing page), including onboarding, KYC and payments for first-time users. Konnect later became the first payment facilitator licensed by the Central Bank of Tunisia.
- Designed the UX/UI and brand identity for a Tunisie Telecom project.

**Freelance Product Designer** · T+ Ingénierie Informatique · Remote — Mar 2020 – Jan 2021

- Designed web apps, admin dashboards and e-commerce sites for SME and enterprise clients, and ran the scoping and client workshops.

## Skills

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| **Product design** | End-to-end product design, problem framing, interaction design, information architecture, responsive and mobile, accessibility (WCAG-aware) |
| **Research** | User interviews, usability testing, journey mapping, service design, A/B testing, analytics-informed iteration |
| **Working with engineering** | Design systems (components, tokens, states), developer handoff, design QA, prototyping in code |
| **Collaboration** | Stakeholder alignment, client workshops, cross-functional facilitation, roadmap input, critique and mentoring |
| **Domains** | AI and machine learning, fintech and payments, B2B SaaS, marketplaces, e-commerce, data-dense dashboards |
| **Tools** | Figma, Framer, ProtoPie, Sketch, Claude Code, Google Analytics, VWO, Midjourney |

## Education

**BTS Communication Visuelle, option Multimédia** · Carthage Art Academy · Tunis — 2017 – 2021

## Languages

Arabic (native) · English (professional) · French (professional)